# NHMEC

# Community Herbalist Diploma

## Level II – Applied Studies

# MODULE 12

# Designing Community Herbal Education Programs

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# Module Overview

A successful Community Herbalist does more than teach individual classes—they develop educational programs that create lasting change within their communities.

Educational programs provide structure, consistency, and opportunities for students to build knowledge over time. Whether teaching a church wellness ministry, a homeschool cooperative, a public library series, or a community garden class, well-designed programs help participants progress from basic concepts to practical application.

This module teaches students how to organize complete educational programs that are engaging, well-planned, ethically presented, and adaptable for different audiences.

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# Module Objectives

Upon successful completion of this module, students will be able to:

• Design a multi-session herbal education program.

• Develop measurable learning objectives.

• Organize lessons into logical sequences.

• Create participant workbooks and instructor guides.

• Adapt educational programs for different audiences.

• Evaluate student learning.

• Develop long-term community education initiatives.

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# Required Reading

Read the sections of the **Community Herbalist eGuide** relating to:

• Community Education

• Teaching Herbal Knowledge

• Public Outreach

• Educational Leadership

• Community Wellness Programs

As you read, identify examples of educational methods that encourage participation and lifelong learning.

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# Learning Outcomes

By the end of this module, students will understand how organized educational programs create stronger communities by encouraging continued learning, stewardship, and practical herbal knowledge.

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# Instructor Lecture

# Beyond the One-Day Workshop

A single workshop can inspire interest.

A structured educational program develops confidence.

Community Herbalists should strive to create educational experiences that build upon previous lessons while encouraging participants to continue learning.

Programs may be offered weekly, monthly, seasonally, or throughout the year.

Consistency creates lasting impact.

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# Identifying Your Audience

Before developing a program, determine who will attend.

Examples include:

Children

Homeschool students

Teenagers

Adults

Senior adults

Church groups

Garden clubs

Libraries

Community centers

Beginning herbalists

Each audience requires different teaching methods, pacing, and activities.

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# Writing Learning Objectives

Every lesson should answer:

What should participants know by the end of this class?

Good learning objectives are:

Clear

Specific

Measurable

Achievable

Relevant

Example:

"Participants will correctly identify five common culinary herbs."

Objectives help both the instructor and the learner.

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# Structuring a Course

Each lesson should include:

Welcome

Review

Learning objectives

Presentation

Demonstration

Hands-on activity

Discussion

Questions

Homework

Closing summary

A consistent format creates a comfortable learning environment.

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# Creating Participant Materials

Every educational program should include:

Student workbook

Lesson outlines

Worksheets

Recipe cards

Plant identification sheets

Resource lists

Vocabulary

Homework assignments

Quizzes

Certificates of completion

High-quality materials improve the learning experience.

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# Instructor Resources

Prepare materials before teaching.

Examples include:

Lesson plans

Presentation notes

Demonstration supplies

Visual aids

Attendance sheets

Evaluation forms

Emergency contact information

Supply inventory

Preparation reduces stress and increases confidence.

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# Evaluating Learning

Evaluation can include:

Short quizzes

Group discussions

Hands-on demonstrations

Worksheets

Reflection journals

Projects

Presentations

Portfolios

Evaluation should encourage learning rather than create fear.

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# Adapting Programs

Educational programs should remain flexible.

A lesson may need adjustments based on:

Age

Experience

Available time

Season

Location

Special needs

Community interests

Adaptability is one of the strengths of an effective educator.

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# Building Long-Term Programs

Community Herbalists may develop:

Six-week herbal courses

Seasonal gardening classes

Children's herbal clubs

Church wellness ministries

Herbal book studies

Garden volunteer programs

Monthly herb clubs

Community seed-saving programs

These long-term programs strengthen relationships and promote continued learning.

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# Biblical Reflection

**2 Timothy 2:2 (KJV)**

*"And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also."*

Biblical teaching emphasizes passing knowledge from one generation to the next. Community Herbalists continue this tradition by equipping others to become wise stewards of God's creation and faithful teachers within their own communities.

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# Vocabulary

Define:

Curriculum

Learning Objective

Lesson Plan

Participant Workbook

Instructor Guide

Evaluation

Workshop Series

Educational Program

Teaching Sequence

Continuing Education

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# Reflection Questions

1. Why are structured educational programs more effective than isolated classes?
2. What audience would you most enjoy teaching?
3. How can learning objectives improve instruction?
4. Why should educational materials be organized before teaching?
5. What teaching methods help students remember information?
6. How can programs be adapted for different age groups?
7. What long-term herbal education program would you like to create?

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# Practical Activity

## Review an Existing Educational Program

Attend or review a course, workshop series, or educational program.

Evaluate:

Organization

Lesson sequence

Student materials

Teaching methods

Participation

Strengths

Suggestions for improvement

Write a two-page evaluation.

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# Curriculum Planning Exercise

Develop a six-session outline.

Include:

Course title

Target audience

Lesson titles

Learning objectives

Activities

Assignments

Resources

Evaluation methods

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# Assignment

## Design a Complete Community Herbal Education Course

Create a professional course suitable for a church, library, homeschool group, community center, or nonprofit organization.

Include:

Course Description

Instructor Biography

Learning Objectives

Six Detailed Lesson Plans

Student Workbook Outline

Instructor Guide

Worksheets

Quizzes

Resource List

Completion Certificate

Course Evaluation Form

Marketing Flyer

Minimum Length:

20–25 pages.

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# Mini Quiz

**1. A structured educational program should include:**

A. Random lessons

B. Organized learning objectives and lesson plans

C. Only demonstrations

D. No evaluation

**2. Learning objectives help:**

A. Confuse students

B. Clarify expected learning outcomes

C. Replace teaching

D. Eliminate discussion

**3. Participant workbooks should contain:**

A. Nothing

B. Educational materials and activities

C. Advertisements

D. Only photographs

**4. Effective educational programs should:**

A. Adapt to the audience

B. Ignore participant needs

C. Never change

D. Avoid planning

**5. Long-term programs help communities by:**

A. Encouraging continued learning

B. Replacing libraries

C. Eliminating volunteers

D. Reducing education

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# Answer Key

1. B
2. B
3. B
4. A
5. A

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# Module Project

## Community Herbal Education Series Portfolio

Develop a professional educational series consisting of **eight classes**.

Examples:

• Community Herbalism Foundations

• Kitchen Herbalism

• Medicinal Herb Gardening

• Herbal Preparations

• Seasonal Herbal Wellness

• Culinary Herbalism

• Herbal Stewardship

• Community Outreach

For each class include:

Lesson Plan

PowerPoint Outline

Student Handout

Worksheet

Quiz

Suggested Demonstration

Homework

Evaluation Form

Promotional Flyer

Supply List

Instructor Notes

The completed portfolio should be suitable for immediate implementation within your community.

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# Community Herbal Journal

Record:

• Five educational programs you would like to teach.

• Three audiences you hope to serve.

• Two improvements you want to make as an educator.

• One long-term vision for your community herbal education ministry.

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# Module Completion Checklist

☐ Required reading completed

☐ Vocabulary completed

☐ Reflection questions answered

☐ Educational program review completed

☐ Six-session curriculum outline completed

☐ Community Herbal Education Course submitted

☐ Education Series Portfolio completed

☐ Quiz passed (80% or higher)

☐ Herbal Journal updated

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# Instructor Challenge (Optional)

Present the first lesson of your educational series to a small audience such as family members, a church group, homeschool cooperative, library program, or community organization.

Collect participant feedback on:

• Organization

• Clarity

• Engagement

• Educational value

• Suggested improvements

Revise your course based on the feedback and include the evaluation in your Community Herbalist Portfolio.

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# Looking Ahead

In **Module 13**, you will explore **Leadership, Volunteer Management & Community Organization**. You will learn how to recruit volunteers, organize teams, manage projects, resolve conflicts, build partnerships, and develop sustainable community herbal initiatives that continue to serve others long after individual events have ended.